But Qāsim Beg did something that annoyed Babur. He showed compassion and let those fifteen captives go free. Babur composed the following poem in *Baburnama* for this incident:[*]

> To do good to the bad is one and the same
> As the doing of ill to the good;
> On brackish soil no spikenard grows,
> Waste no seed of toil upon it.

The rest of the prisoners were released on compassionate grounds as well.

While Babur was busy raiding the Turkmān Hazāras, news of political turbulence came from Kābul. Muḥammad Ḥusain Mīrzā Dūghlāt and Sulṭān Sanjar Barlās had come over to the Moghūls left in Kābul. They declared Mīrzā Khān (Wais) the Padishah. They laid siege to the fort and spread a rumour that Badī'u'z-zamān Mīrzā and Muẓaffar Mīrzā had made Babur a prisoner in Fort Ikhtiyāru'd-dīn (also known as Ālā-qūrghān). But people in command, including Mullā Bābā of Pashāghar, Khalīfa, Muḥibb-i-'alī the armourer, Aḥmad-i-yūsuf and Aḥmad-i-qāsim were able to strengthen the fort and didn't let it fell.

Without wasting a single moment, Qāsim Beg's servant, Muhammad of Andijān, a Tūqbāī was sent to the begs of Kābul from Timur's Langar. He had a written message to deliver:[*]

> When we are out of the Ghūr-bund narrows, we will fall on them suddenly; let our signal to you be the fire we will light directly we have passed Minār-hill; do you in reply light one in the citadel, on the old Kūshk (kiosk), now the Treasury, so that we may be sure you know of our coming. We will come up from our side; you come out from yours; neglect nothing your hands can find to do!

Babur and his men began to ride the very next dawn from the langar and dismounted around Ushtur-shahr. By the next morning, they passed the Ghūr-bund narrows and dismounted at the bridgehead. They made the horses drink water and rest for a while before resuming the journey to Kābul around the mid-day prayer. The snow was completely absent till they reached the Toll Gate (Annette Susannah Beveridge has also translated *tūtqāwal* as Toll Gate). The more they proceeded beyond the tool the more the snow deepened. Between the node of Ẕamma-yakhshī and Minār, the piercing cold was such that Babur had never experienced before.